

Barnsley FC Fan Advisory Group Meeting Minutes

Date of Meeting	Tuesday 13 th May 2025
Location	Premier Suite, Oakwell Stadium
Time	6:30 pm
Meeting Objective(s)	

Attendance

Present		Apologies	
John Bird – JB – minute taker	Steve Brain – SB	Andy Gaskell – AG	
Jon Flatman - JF	Robin Harris – RH	Dominic Wood - DW	
Phil Hall - PH	Paul Gallagher – PG		
Martin Wilson – MW	Curtis Ledger – CL		
Kelly Drury – KD	Heather Linney - HL		
Claire Calton – CC			

Agenda, Discussions, Issues

Topic / Discussion Notes	Discussion led by
1. Minutes and feedback	
April minutes approved by FAB members. JB to update on to template and publish.	
2. Hoyland reds presentation evening	
Players visits were cancelled on the morning of the event. Apology received the following morning from 1st team manager Conor Hourihane. Club also apologised for the cancellation. Moving forward, better organisation on the date with the club so that we can look to make players available. It would be better if the event wasn't before matchdays as to not rule out any player attending.	
3. SLO tenure	
HL had a chat with Alan Bloore. Wondered if there was a period of time that a person would be in the SLO role as with members of the FAB. Alan Bloore has been named in the latest EFL Family Excellence award for providing excellent communication and support to new attendees attending their first fixture.	
4. Minutes applause at fixtures	
Red's Remembered is the official applause for supporters who have passed away. The minutes applause are usually fan driven and promoted on social media. Club will always support at the appropriate levels.	
5. Visually impaired commentary/ EFL audio Descriptor - Update	
MW finding it difficult to get in touch with other FAB groups to find out what facilities they have. Long term to gather information and MW not giving up on making a change. Field of vision trialist were selected from the EFL innovation lab. Port Vale were the trial club. JB has asked the EFL to be included in any future trials. JF to speak to the EFL as well to find out how the trial has gone at the next meeting in June.	
6. Independent fan survey results	
Daniel Simms has contacted FAB to discuss the results of the survey. This will be completed after the results have been analysed. The results should then be shared with the club to review and to look to implement any changes which are practical from the findings.	
7. Visibility from the disabled stand	
The club are going to review the view from the disabled stand during the close season. There is room to move supporters around in that area. The club are also looking at the possibility of adding more accessible bays in EL1.	

8. Barnsley Civic Trust – George Robledo					
Book launch in library for George Robledo. Barnsley Civic trust asked about the possibility of placing a blue plaque on the wall at Oakwell. JF asked FAB to find out some more information.					
9. Future meeting dates					
Thursday 12 th June and 8 th July – Both on teams.					
10. AOB					
PG asked about the statue – JB/JF to talk to Daniel Simms when the results of the fan survey are presented to the club.					
CC asked about the lottery discount on the season tickets being included without having to buy and then get refund. JB mentioned that the systems are separate so discount needs to be manually applied. JB suggested to contact the club before purchasing to apply discount.					
PG asked about the questions to the ownership group – JF suggested that they are presented in written form to via JF first and then the answers can be given in writing or via a teams call.					
PG spoke to Steve Crofts about the tickets from DW – Steve to speak to his contacts from flag bearing to offer the tickets out on a match-by-match basis.					
SB asked about a kiosk not showing pricing in the East Stand – JF confirmed that all kiosks will have a signage refresh for the new season.					
Fixture release date is 26 th June at 12pm – will have a fixture release lunch					
Kit update – More information to follow					
Fanzone – Objections have been received. Going to planning hearing when we have more information.					
Family excellence report – we have achieved the bronze award for last season. JB to share the results with FAB. A special mention to Alan Bloore was made in the second report for his help with a new family attending Oakwell for the first time.					
Terms of reference review by the group before the next meeting.					
JF said the club are looking at a Fans forum before the beginning of the season which is open to everyone – We are also looking to set up a Fan engagement forum before the start of the season too.					
FAB would like to have an online meeting where supporters can attend and ask questions or have a chat with FAB. Look to set something up in the future.					
Closed – 19:45					
Action Items					
Action Log			Responsible		Due Date
Next Meeting					
Date:	12.06.25	Time:	6.30 pm	Location:	Microsoft Teams